KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Define the value:** make the cost of poor governance impossible to ignore, and quantify the upside
- **Know your audience:** frame the value around what each leader — CFO, CTO, business — cares about most
- **Build momentum:** win with a focused, high-impact pilot, then scale on those early results
- **Prepare for objections:** reframe “too slow,” “just IT,” and “can’t afford it” as the case for governance
- **Communicate progress:** report in business language with a one-pager. Current state, metrics, progress, next steps

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

COURSE PROJECT: BUILDING A GOVERNANCE FOUNDATION



THE SITUATION

You work for **MavenBridge Insurance Group**, a mid-sized US property and casualty insurer.

After three acquisitions, MavenBridge runs claims, underwriting, and customer data across four systems with no agreed owners. Two business units report different customer counts, and a regulator has asked how the company controls data quality.



THE ASSIGNMENT

You have been asked to lay the foundation for MavenBridge's data governance program. Using the provided company context, **select an operating model, assess current maturity, and define the principles and first policy that will guide the program.**



THE OBJECTIVES

- Select a governance model (centralized, decentralized, or federated) and justify the fit
- Score MavenBridge against the provided maturity rubrik and note key gaps
- Define two core governance principles that address those gaps
- Identify one topic you would write a governance policy about, and why

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

COURSE PROJECT: ADDITIONAL CONTEXT

Company Overview

- MavenBridge Insurance Group is a mid-sized US property and casualty insurer, writing roughly $2.1B in premium across personal auto and small commercial lines in 12 states. It has grown through three acquisitions since 2019.

Data Environment

- Customer, policy, and claims data sit in four core systems carried over from those acquisitions, plus a new cloud warehouse. There is no enterprise data dictionary, and ownership sits informally with IT.

Culture & Silos

- Each acquired unit kept its own definitions, spreadsheets, and reporting team. Analysts treat their extracts as local property, sharing happens by favor, and "our numbers" routinely beat enterprise numbers. Leaders reward speed over consistency.

Regulation

- As an insurer, MavenBridge faces state DOI market conduct exams, the NAIC Insurance Data Security Model Law, GLBA privacy and safeguards rules, HIPAA for health-related claims, and state laws such as CCPA/CPRA.

The Challenge

- Two units report different active-customer counts, and quality issues surface only after reports are published. A state regulator has asked MavenBridge to document how it ensures claims data accuracy. Leadership wants a program in 90 days.

Your Role

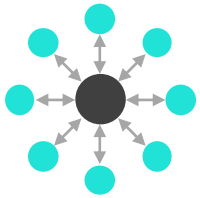
- You lead a business unit at MavenBridge, and leadership has asked you to partner with the enterprise governance lead and a governance analyst to stand up a new program. In three weeks, you present a governance foundation: an operating model, a maturity assessment against the rubric, two principles, and a first policy topic.

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

CHOOSE YOUR GOVERNANCE MODEL

Business Units
Data Governance Organization

☑ CENTRALIZED

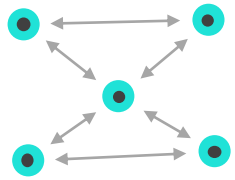


Central Data Governance organization oversees all activities in all subject areas

Pros: *Consistency, Accountability*

Cons: *Imposition, Bottleneck*

☐ DECENTRALIZED

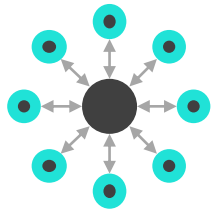


Data Governance operations and standards are adopted by **each business unit**

Pros: *Business ownership, fast decision-making*

Cons: *Conflicting practices and definitions, inefficient, difficulty sharing data*

☐ FEDERATED



Data Governance organization **coordinates** across business units to maintain consistent definitions and standards

Pros: *Flexibility, Alignment*

Cons: *Rigorous coordination, stakeholder engagement*

For the mini project, **start from a standard model** instead of considering a hybrid option.

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

FILL OUT MATURITY ASSESSMENT TEMPLATE

		SCORING RUBRIC					
STANDARD		1 – Aware	2 – Reactive	3 – Proactive	4 – Mature	5 – Optimized	SCORE
People	*We have defined governance roles, and they are assigned to named individuals.*	✅					*4*
People	*There is clear executive sponsorship for governance at the leadership level.*			✅			
Process	*We have defined, repeatable processes for resolving data quality issues*	✅					*5*
Process	*Governance decisions are made proactively and strategically, not reactively.*	✅					
Technology	*We have tools that support governance, such as a data catalog or quality monitoring.*	✅					*5*
Technology	*Our governance tooling is integrated into day-to-day data workflows.*	✅					
Culture	*Teams see data governance as an enabler of better decisions, not as red tape.*	✅					*5*
Culture	*There is organizational appetite to keep improving data governance over time.*		✅				

CHOOSE TWO RELEVANT GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLES

☑	**ACCOUNTABILITY**	**Clear ownership** must be defined; every critical data asset needs a **named Data Owner** accountable for quality, definitions, and access decisions.
☐	**AVAILABILITY**	The right data must be **easy to find and reach** by those who need it. Access is granted within the controls that keep sensitive data protected.
☐	**TRANSPARENCY**	Operations, **data lineage**, and **decision criteria** should be visible and documented for users across the enterprise
☑	**UNDERSTANDING**	Organizations must develop unified definitions, standards, and **Business Glossaries** to ensure data is consistent across all domains
☐	**DATA QUALITY**	**Quality expectations** must be explicit, measured, and continuously monitored, rather than just assumed
☐	**COMPLIANCE & SECURITY**	Data must be **classified, secured**, and **monitored** to satisfy both internal policies and external regulations
☐	**ETHICS**	Data must be utilized in ways that are **fair, non-discriminatory**, and aligned with stakeholder expectations